



ON AIR

DIALOGUES

KNOWLEDGE SHARING ABOUT UNPAID CARE

Across the globe, care work is an essential driver of society: it sustains communities and economies; provides care for children, sick and elderly people, and those living with disabilities; and sustains households and families. Care work is often viewed as a natural extension of women's role, resulting in an unequal balance of care work assumed. Such disparity limits their opportunities to participate in decently paid employment, education, leisure and political life. Excessive responsibility and unequal constraints perpetuate cycles of poverty for women and girls, preventing them from being part of solutions.

Farm Radio International's intervention, funded by Global Affairs Canada and implemented with the support of strategic partnerships with FEMNET, UN Women, and key national women's rights organizations and stakeholders, equipped decision-makers, duty-bearers and community members with the resources to advocate for a wider commitment to change and address issues of unpaid care work. After all, shifting existing paradigms requires recognition of the value of unpaid care work and the women who fulfill this work. Community dialogues, wider advocacy and general communication efforts with those affected and rights holders are an essential step.

Following the successful completion of the On Air Dialogues in Burkina Faso, Ethiopia, Malawi, Nigeria and Tanzania, national convening meetings were conducted in these countries to assess the outcomes and evaluate their policy relevance within the respective contexts.

Additionally, the outputs from these national meetings will be collectively examined in a two-day workshop in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia. This event convenes government representatives, unpaid care work actors, and On Air Dialogue contributors and participants to review findings and insights from participating populations and identify opportunities to better promote equitable sharing of care work and public investments and policies that reduce the weight of care work.



KEY FINDINGS

Unpaid Care Work and Domestic Responsibilities:

Women across all countries tend to spend a significant portion of their day on unpaid care work and domestic tasks. There are variations by country and gender, but in general, women tend to spend more time on these activities compared to men.

Perceptions of Unpaid Care Work:

There is a mix of perceptions regarding unpaid care work. Some view it as a heavy and exhausting amount of work, while others find it manageable or easy. The perception of who should be responsible for unpaid care work varies, with some advocating for equal sharing among household members and others endorsing traditional gender roles.

Gender Roles and Responsibilities:

Women are often perceived as primarily responsible for unpaid care tasks and domestic work, although there are shifts in attitudes towards more equal sharing of responsibilities. Younger men tend to be more involved in unpaid care work compared to older generations, indicating changing gender roles over time.

Challenges and Priorities for Governments:

Key challenges identified include the need for more childcare facilities, better access to health care services, improved infrastructure (such as water and fuel sources), and enhanced safety and security, especially for women and girls. The priorities for governments vary by country and gender, with some emphasizing childcare facilities, others focusing on health care services, and some prioritizing safety and security measures.

Cultural Norms and Acceptance:

Cultural norms play a significant role in shaping perceptions of unpaid care work, with some viewing it as an essential part of their culture and others advocating for changes to make it easier, especially for women.

Impact on Society and Communities:

The sharing of unpaid care work and domestic responsibilities within households has implications for societal norms, with some viewing it as a reflection of societal values and others seeing it as an opportunity for positive change and setting examples for the community.



WHAT ARE ON AIR DIALOGUES?

On Air Dialogues are designed to combine radio programs that catch people's attention and promote in-depth thinking about a topic with mobile-phone based polling. On air, broadcasters invite local experts, community members, and guests to speak their minds and share their knowledge. Off air, we engage listeners to join in the discussion with their own thoughts.

In partnership with the Government of Canada through Global Affairs Canada (GAC), national governments, UN Women, FEMNET and national women's rights organizations (WRO), Farm Radio International worked with 16 radio stations to create 48 original episodes of radio programming, complete with mobile phone-based listener polling.

We conducted a poll that gathered insights and perspectives on unpaid care work in homes from thousands of adult women, men and youth, aiming to capture a diverse range of viewpoints and experiences.

We sought to gain insight into their understanding of unpaid care work, explore the social norms surrounding it and understand the necessary steps for effecting change.

WHY USE RADIO?

Radio can reach the most remote, rural and vulnerable communities in sub-Saharan Africa—places where literacy is low and the internet is too expensive to access. Broadcasting in local languages, radio is an inexpensive and convenient way to reach communities that might not otherwise be reached.

Combined with mobile phones, radio becomes a powerful tool for dialogue and engagement.

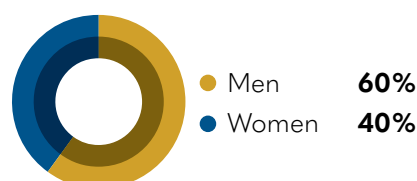
Farm Radio International's Uliza Interactive service combines radio, mobile phones, and Interactive Voice Response systems to enable listeners to communicate and exchange information immediately with their radio station quickly, easily, and free of charge. When combined with interactive radio programming, Uliza is a powerful tool for the general population to join important conversations.

WE ASKED, WHO ANSWERED?

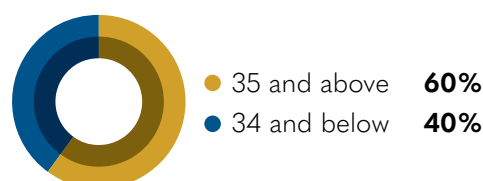
10 LANGUAGES

Nuni, Moore, Oromifa, Wolayetigna, Kembatigna, Hausa, Yoruba, Swahili, Tumbuka, Chichewa

GENDER



AGE



**Amplifying women's voices is vital. Through strategic partnerships with women's rights groups and key stakeholders, the On Air Dialogues significantly boosted women's participation, resulting in a remarkable increase in engagement compared to previous and self-initiated surveys.*

HOW LISTENER POLLING WORKS

Each episode in the On Air Dialogues poses a series of questions to listeners after a discussion hosted on air.



As advertised on the radio program, listeners can use any mobile phone to leave a missed call (or "beep") to a phone number advertised on the radio program.



Uliza Interactive, Farm Radio's polling tool, returns the call, free of charge.



Uliza presents the caller with a series of multiple-choice questions. Callers respond by pressing numbers on the keypad.



Uliza also presents the caller with an open-ended question. Callers record a voice message in response.



Responses to multiple-choice questions are analyzed and disaggregated to shed light on key themes by country, age and gender. Voice messages are similarly analyzed and documented.

SOCIO-DEMOGRAPHIC INFORMATION

5
COUNTRIES

16
RADIO STATIONS

48
ORIGINAL EPISODES

20,355
TOTAL CALLERS

95,951
POLL RESPONSES

13,937
AUDIO COMMENTS

11,150
TOTAL UNIQUE RESPONDENTS

EPISODE 1: INTRODUCTION TO UNPAID CARE

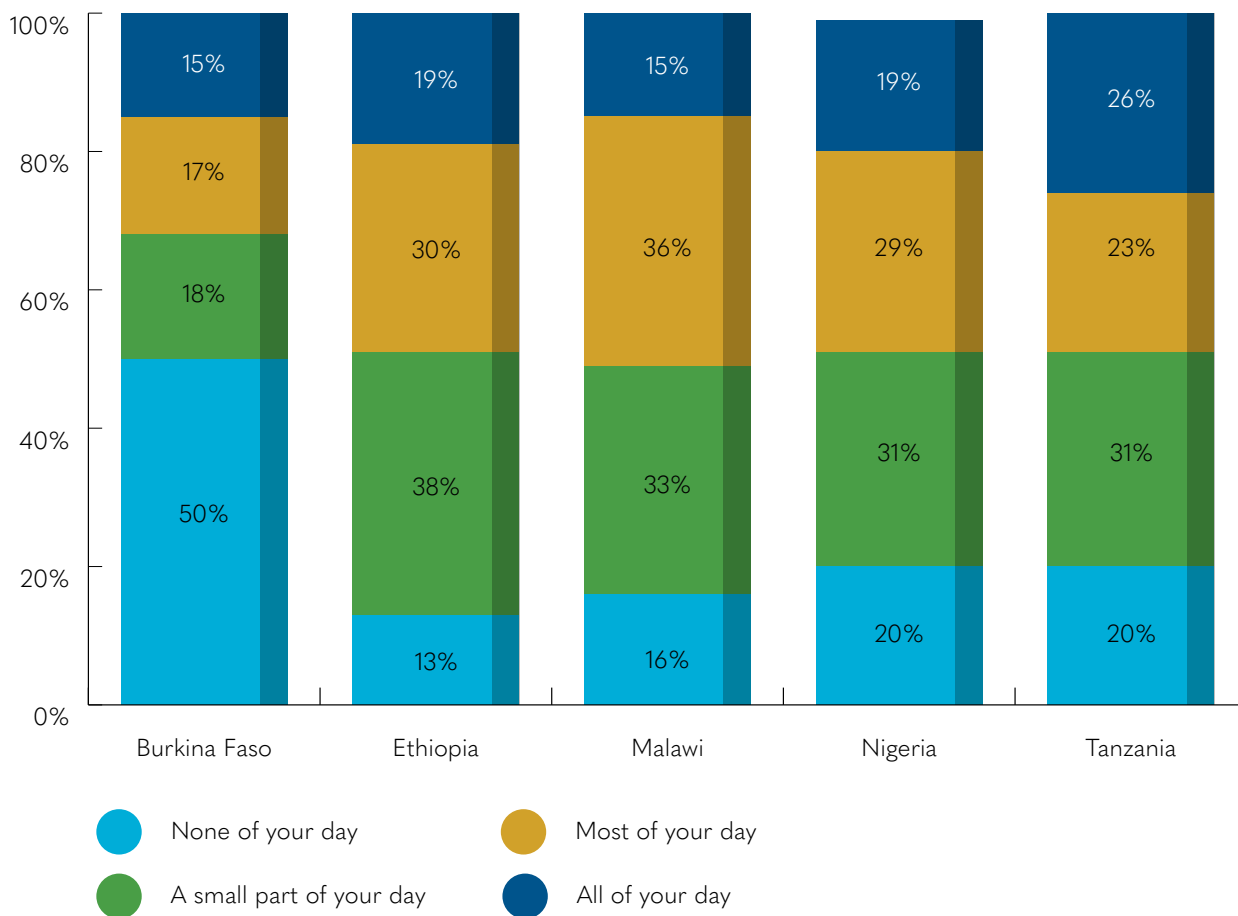
In episode one, we asked respondents four closed-ended questions.

QUESTION 1

HOW MUCH OF YOUR DAY GOES TOWARD DOING UNPAID ACTIVITIES TO ENSURE THE CARE AND SAFETY OF YOUR FAMILY?

1. None of your day
2. A small part of your day
3. Most of your day
4. All of your day

Figure 1: Responses to amount of time spent on unpaid care activities



In Burkina Faso, a significant portion of respondents reported that none of their day goes toward unpaid care activities, while a relatively balanced percentage reported spending a small part, most or all of their day on these activities.

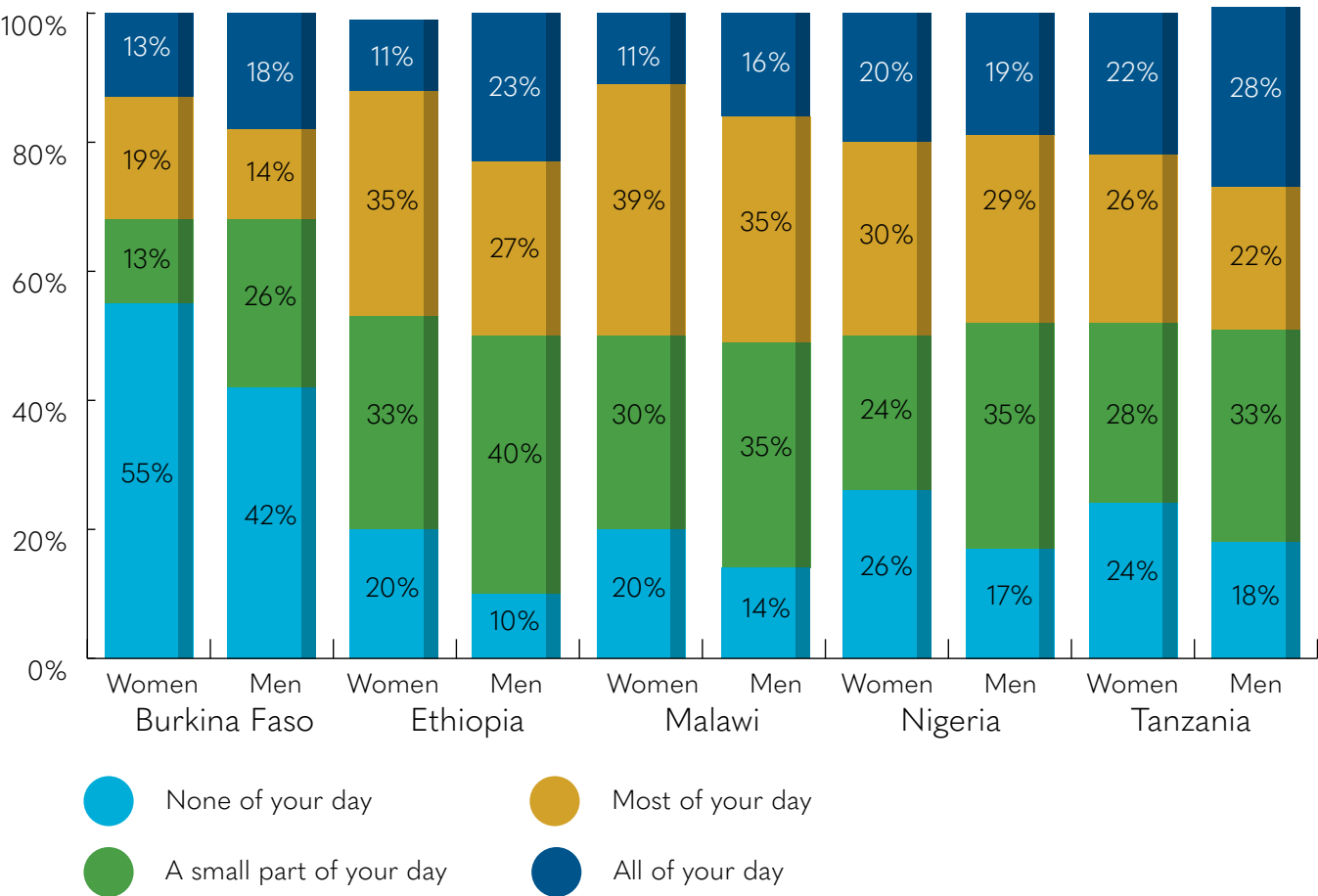
In Ethiopia, there is a notable proportion of people who indicated that only a small part of their day is dedicated to unpaid care work, followed by roughly equal percentages for most of the day and all of the day.

Malawi shows a similar trend to Ethiopia, with a relatively high percentage reporting that most of their day is spent on unpaid care activities.

Nigeria has a relatively balanced distribution across the categories, with a slight majority reporting that a small part of their day goes toward unpaid care work.

Tanzania has a more varied distribution compared to the other countries, with a significant percentage reporting that all of their day is dedicated to unpaid care activities.

Figure 2: Responses to amount of time spent on unpaid care activities by gender



When disaggregated by gender, in Burkina Faso, men tend to spend more of their day on unpaid care work compared to women. Women are more likely to report that none of their day goes toward these activities. In Ethiopia, women are more likely than men to spend most of their day on unpaid care work, while men are more likely to report spending only a small part of their day on these activities.

Women in Malawi also tend to spend more of their day on unpaid care work compared to men, with a higher percentage reporting that most of their day is dedicated to these activities.

Nigeria has a more balanced distribution between genders, but women are slightly more likely to report spending most of their day on unpaid care work.

Both women and men in Tanzania report significant time spent on unpaid care work, with relatively similar percentages across the categories.

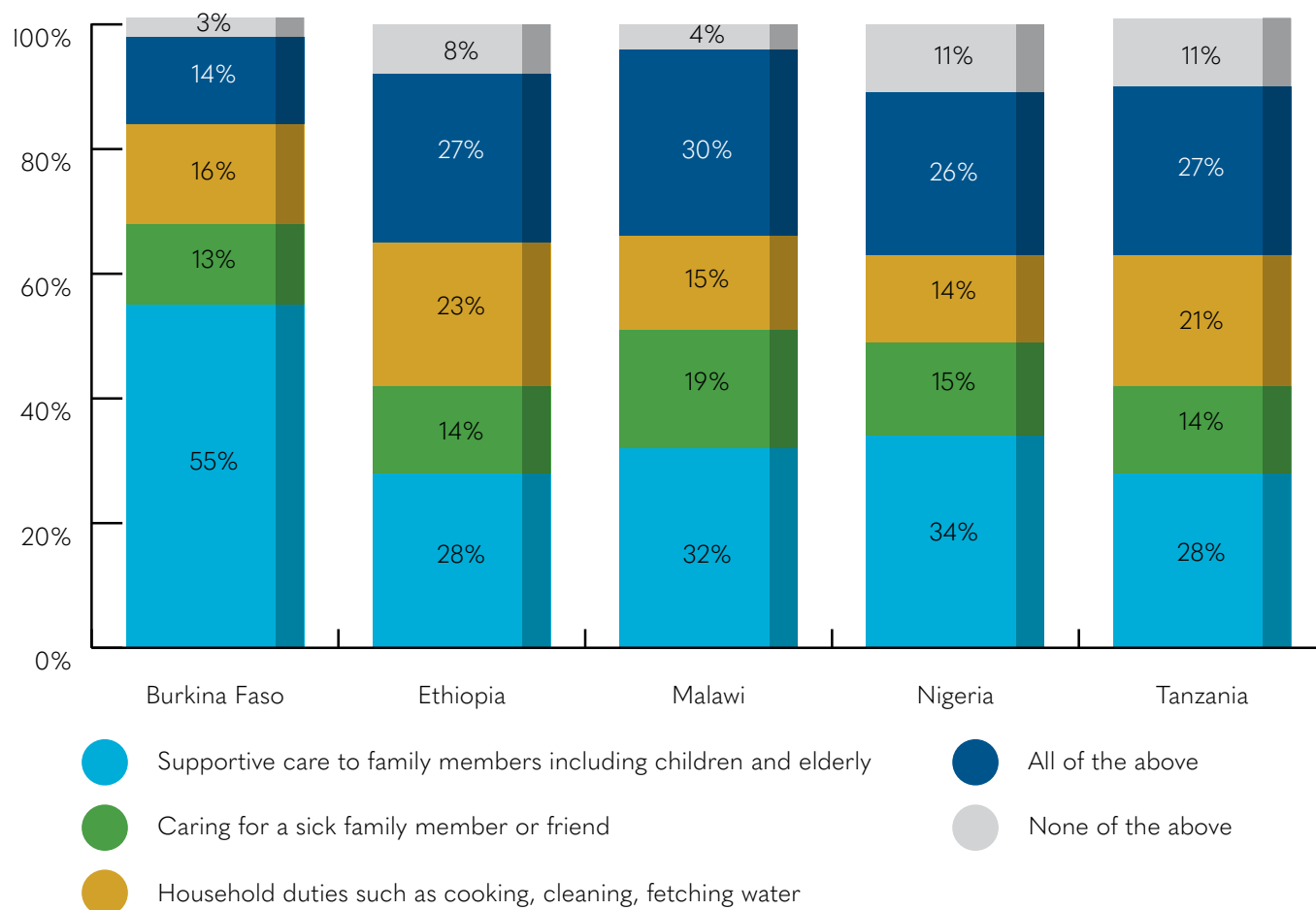
Overall, these gender-disaggregated data show that women in these countries generally spend more time on unpaid care work compared to men, although there are variations across countries. Understanding these differences is crucial for addressing gender disparities in caregiving responsibilities.

QUESTION 2

WHICH OF THESE DO YOU THINK IS CATEGORIZED AS UNPAID CARE WORK?

1. Supportive care to family members including children and elderly
2. Caring for a sick family member or friend
3. Household duties such as cooking, cleaning, fetching water
4. All of the above
5. None of the above

Figure 3: Which of these do you think is categorized as unpaid care work?



Burkina Faso: A significant percentage of respondents engage in supportive care to family members, caring for sick individuals and household duties. About 13.80% reported engaging in all of these activities.

Ethiopia: The data show a higher engagement in caring for sick family members or friends, household duties and all of the mentioned activities compared to supportive care to family members.

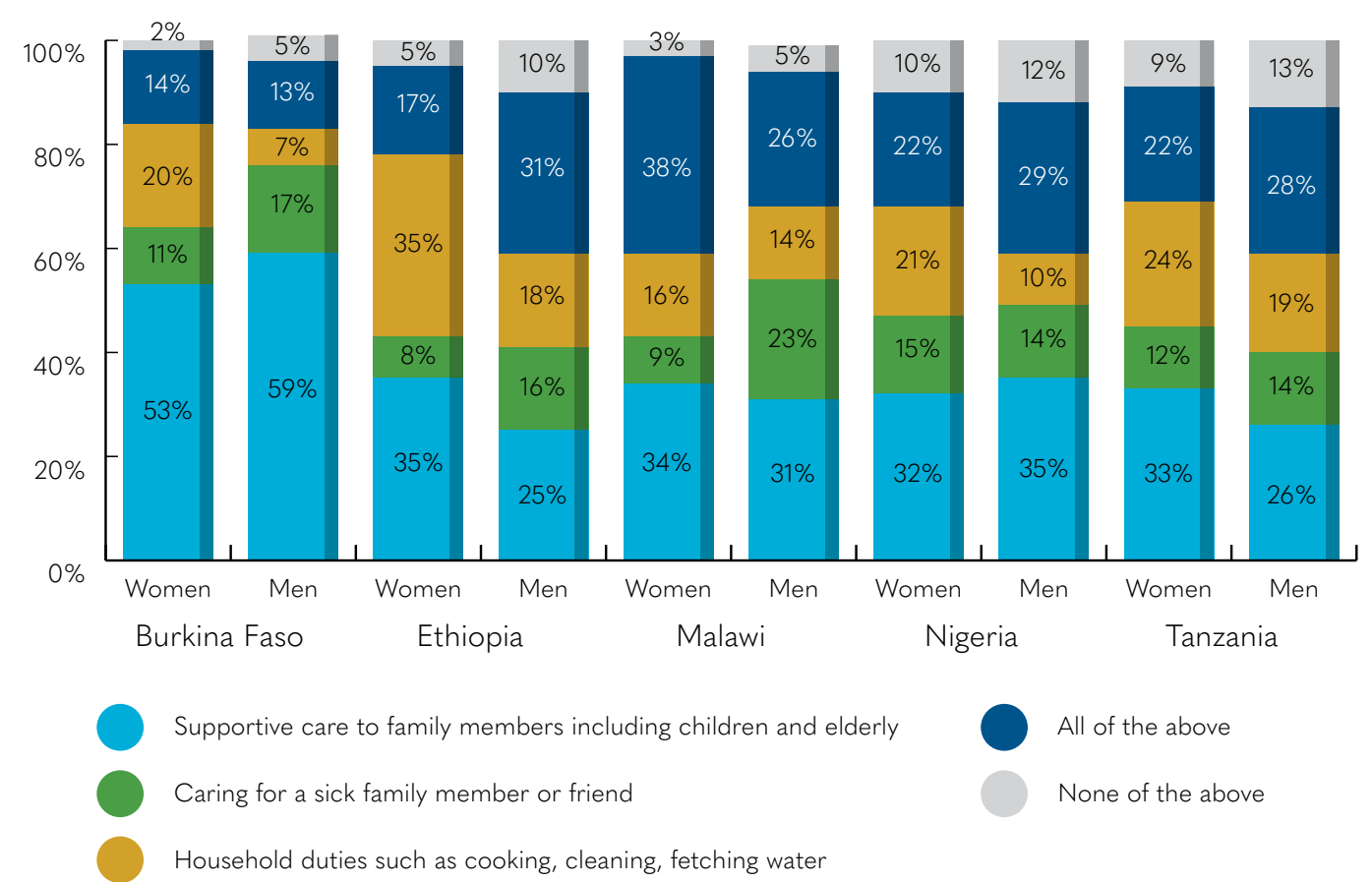
Malawi: There's a notable percentage of respondents engaged in all the mentioned activities, particularly supportive care, caring for sick individuals and household duties.

Nigeria: Similar to Ethiopia, caring for sick family members or friends and household duties are more prominent, with about 26.20% reporting all of the mentioned activities.

Tanzania: The distribution is relatively balanced across the categories, with a significant proportion engaged in all of the activities.

Overall, these findings highlight the widespread nature of unpaid care work across these countries, with varying degrees of engagement depending on the specific activity and country context.

Figure 4: Response to categorization of unpaid care work by gender



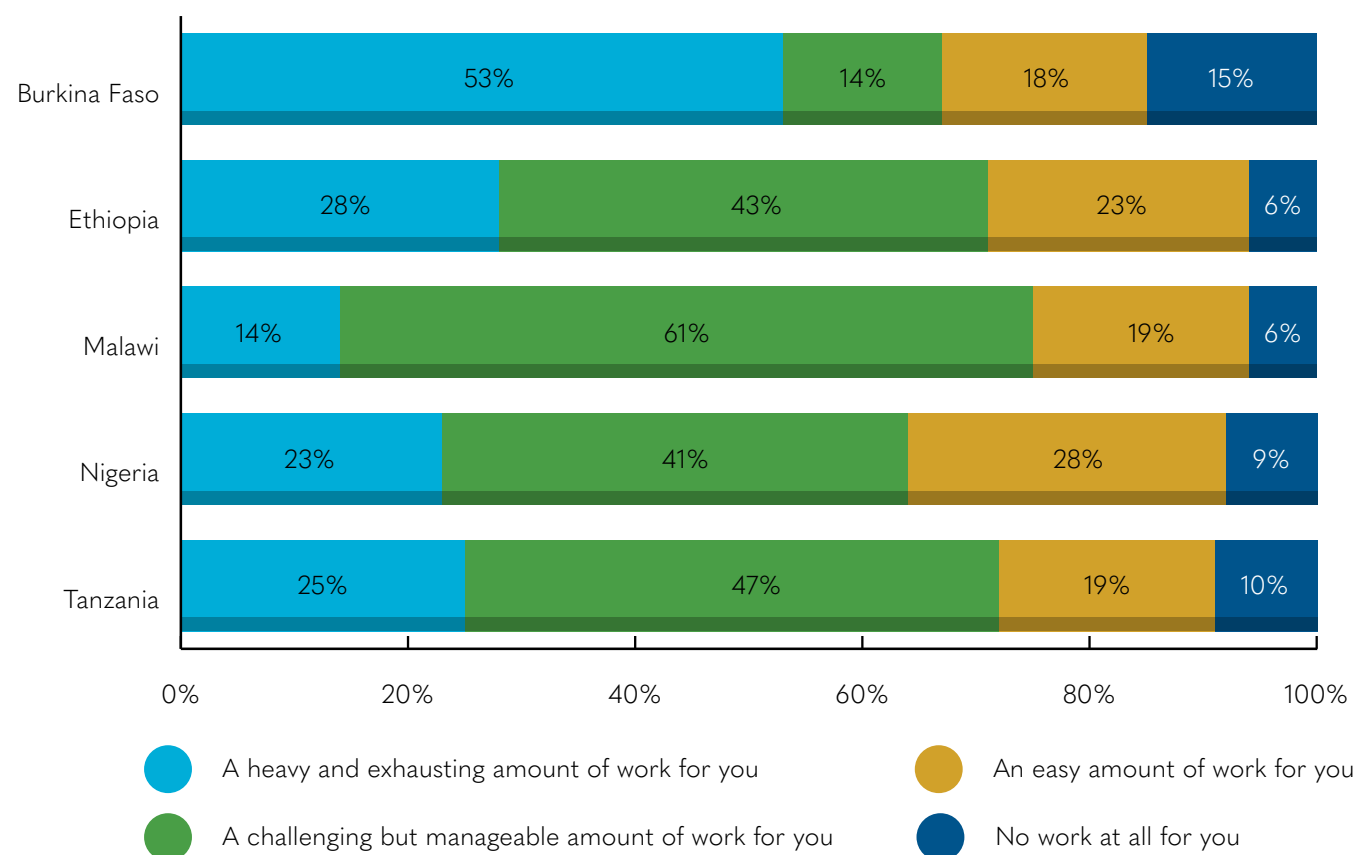
The gender-disaggregated analysis of categories of unpaid care work across the five countries reveals that women generally have higher percentages of engagement in supportive care for family members, caring for sick family members and household duties compared to men. Specifically, women in Burkina Faso and Tanzania show a higher overall engagement in these activities compared to men, while men in Ethiopia and Nigeria exhibit higher percentages in “all of the above,” indicating a broader range of unpaid care work activities. Additionally, a small percentage of both men and women in each country report none of the mentioned activities as unpaid care work.

QUESTION 3

THINK ABOUT THE AMOUNT OF WORK THAT IS INVOLVED FOR YOU IN CARING FOR THE NEEDS OF YOUR FAMILY AT HOME. IT IS:

1. A heavy and exhausting amount of work for you
2. A challenging but manageable amount of work for you
3. An easy amount of work for you
4. No work at all for you

Figure 5: Response to amount of unpaid care work done at home



In Burkina Faso, a majority of respondents perceive caring for family needs at home as a heavy and exhausting amount of work. A smaller but significant percentage also finds it challenging but manageable.

While a substantial percentage in Ethiopia considers it challenging but manageable, a considerable portion also finds it to be a heavy and exhausting amount of work.

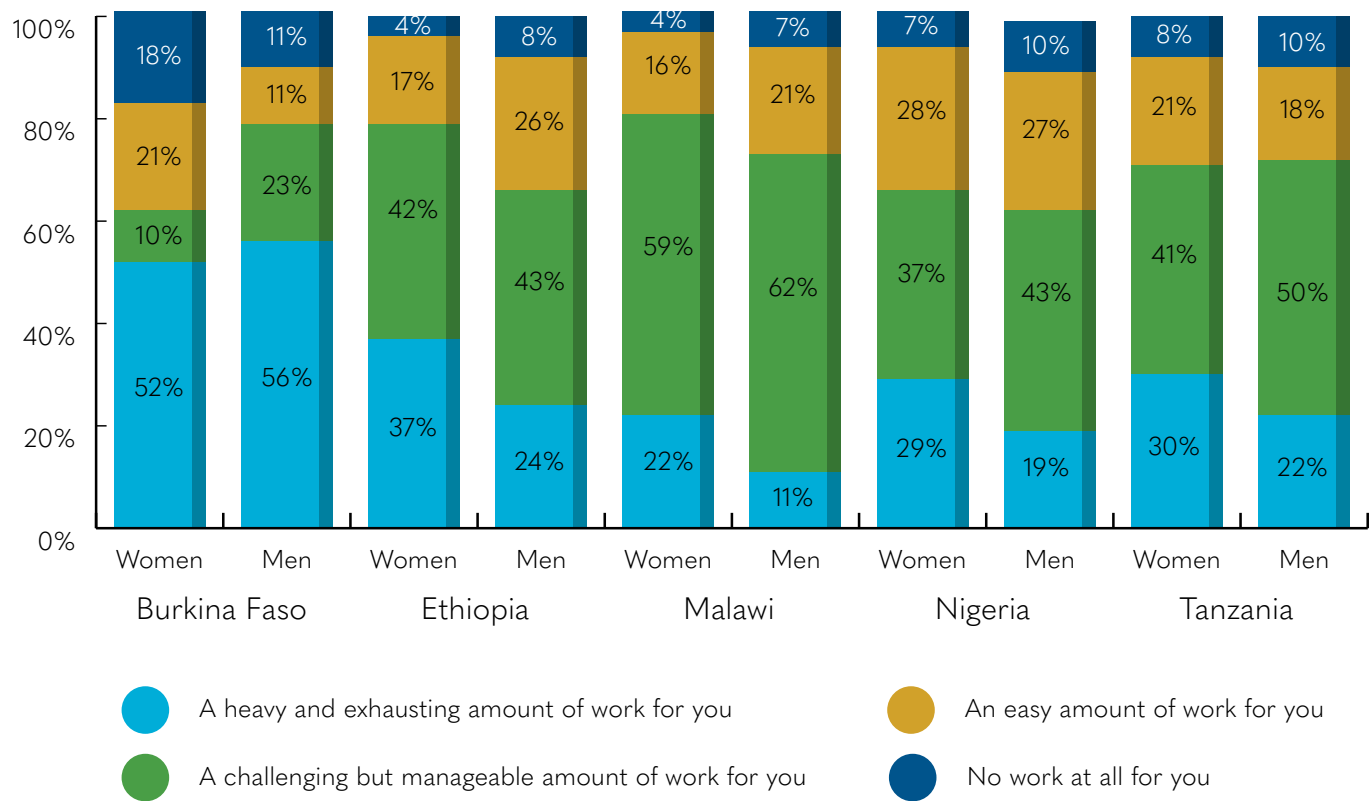
The majority of respondents in Malawi find caring for family needs at home to be a challenging but manageable amount of work. A smaller percentage finds it easy, and an even smaller percentage reports no work at all.

Similar to Ethiopia, a significant percentage in Nigeria finds caring for family needs to be a challenging but manageable amount of work, while a notable percentage perceives it as heavy and exhausting.

A substantial percentage in Tanzania also perceive caring for family needs as a challenging but manageable amount of work, with smaller percentages finding it easy or reporting no work at all.

Overall, the data suggest that a significant portion of respondents across these countries perceives caring for family needs at home as either heavy and exhausting or challenging but manageable, highlighting the substantial workload associated with household responsibilities.

Figure 6: Responses to the amount of unpaid care work done at home by gender



Across all countries, women tend to perceive caring for family needs as a heavier and more exhausting task compared to men. Men, on the other hand, are more likely to perceive the task as challenging but manageable.

In Malawi, both men and women overwhelmingly see the work as challenging but manageable, indicating a shared perception of the workload's intensity. The data also suggest that a notable percentage of men in Ethiopia, Nigeria and Tanzania find the work easy compared to women in the same countries.

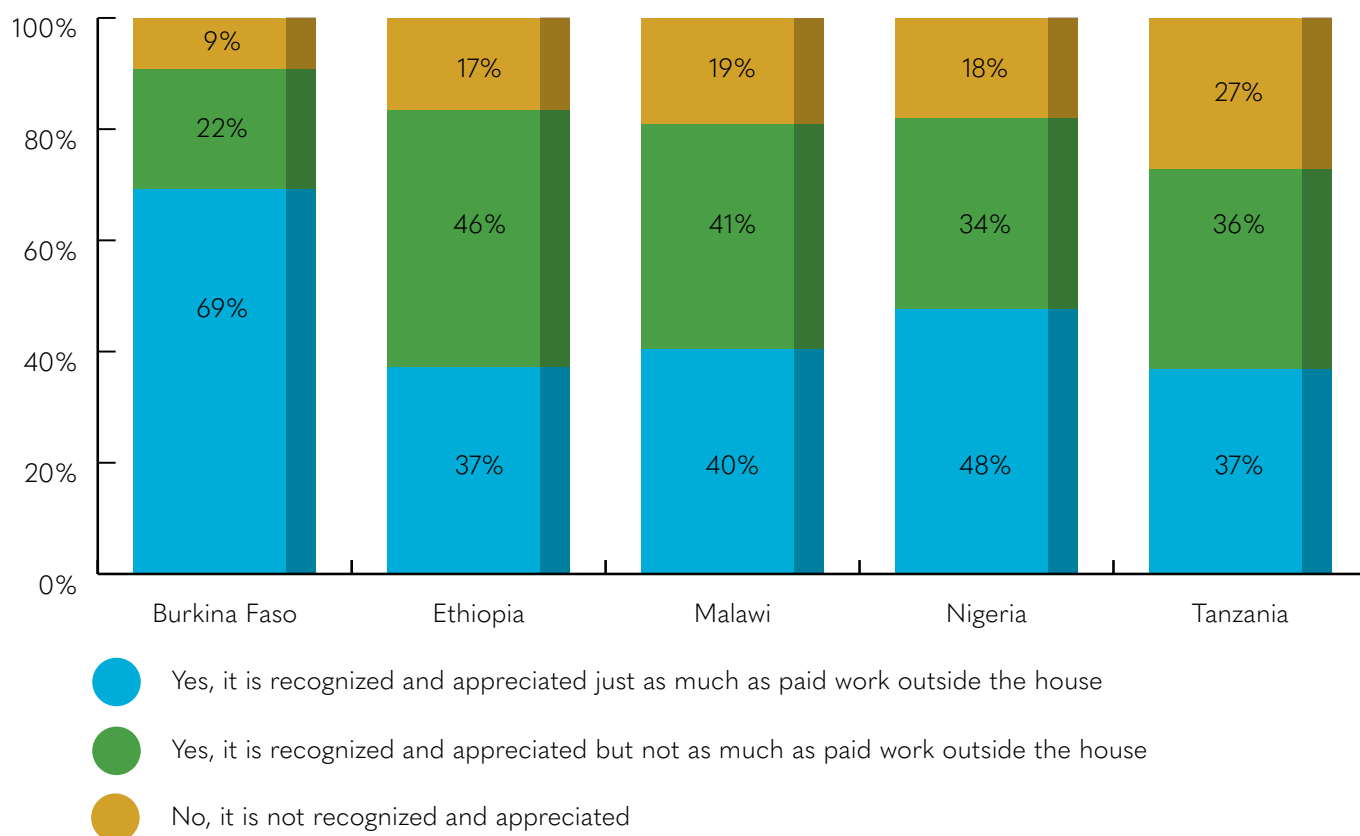
Overall, gender differences in the perception of caregiving workload are evident, with women generally perceiving it as heavier and more exhausting than men.

QUESTION 4

DOES YOUR SOCIETY RECOGNIZE AND APPRECIATE UNPAID DOMESTIC AND CARING WORK?

1. Yes, it is recognized and appreciated just as much as paid work outside the house
2. Yes, it is recognized and appreciated but not as much as paid work outside the house
3. No, it is not recognized and appreciated

Figure 7: Responses to recognition and appreciation of unpaid care



In Burkina Faso, a majority of respondents believe that society recognizes and appreciates unpaid domestic and caring work just as much as paid work outside the house. A smaller percentage feels that it is recognized but not to the same extent, and an even smaller percentage believes it is not recognized and appreciated.

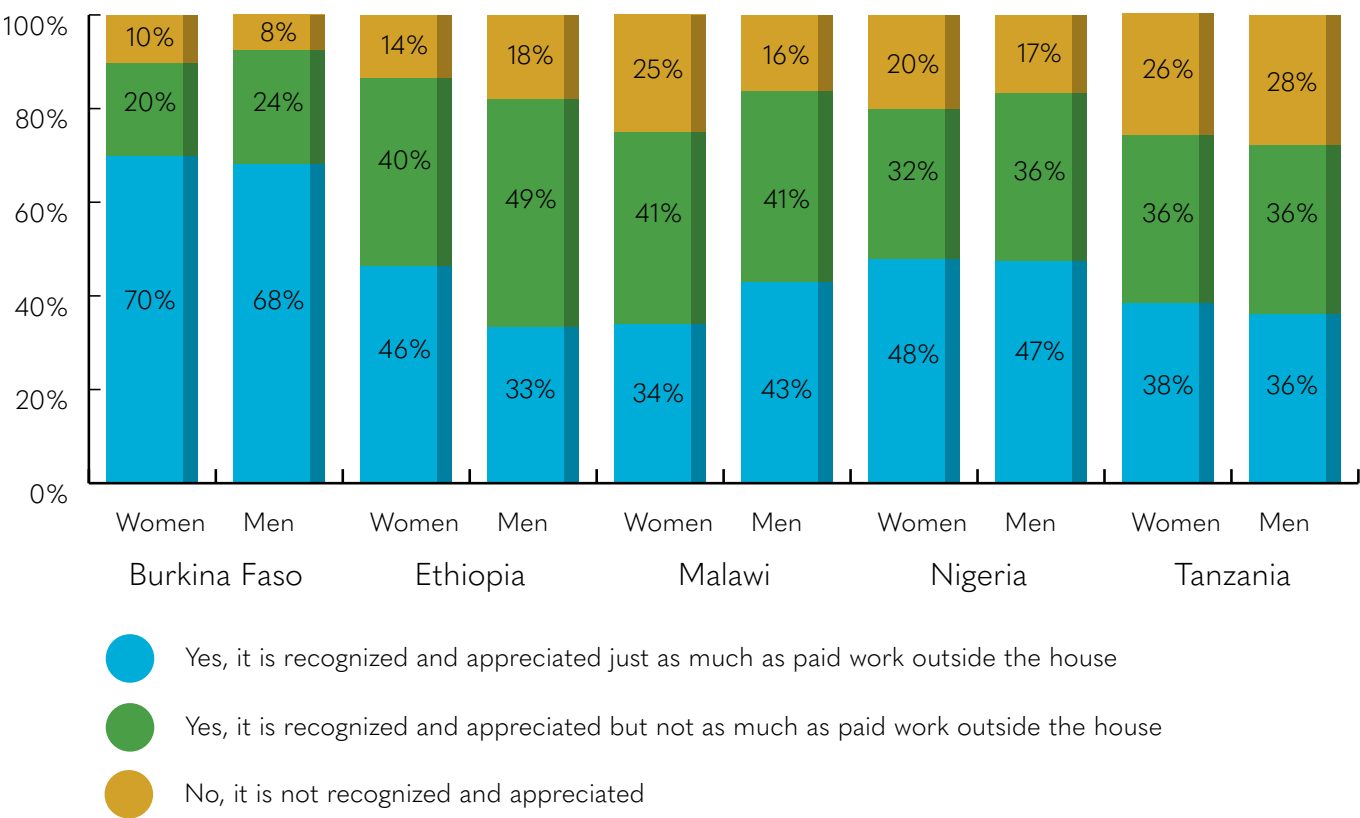
For Ethiopia, the data show a more divided perception, with a significant percentage feeling that such work is recognized but not as much as paid work outside the house. However, a notable portion still believes it is recognized and appreciated just as much.

In Malawi, similar to Ethiopia, there is a split in opinions, with a significant percentage feeling that such work is recognized but not as much as paid work outside the house.

While in Nigeria, a sizable proportion of respondents think that unpaid domestic and caring work is recognized and appreciated just as much as paid work outside the house, while a significant but smaller percentage feels it is recognized but to a lesser extent.

In Tanzania, the data show a mixed perception, with a notable portion believing that such work is recognized just as much as paid work outside the house, but a substantial percentage also feels it is recognized but not to the same extent.

Figure 8: Responses to recognition and appreciation of unpaid care by gender



Across the board, there’s a perception among both men and women that unpaid domestic and caring work is recognized and appreciated, although to varying degrees.

In Burkina Faso, and Ethiopia, women generally have a higher percentage believing that such work is recognized and appreciated just as much as paid work outside the house compared to men.

In Malawi and Tanzania, a significant proportion of women say that unpaid care work is not recognized and appreciated.

In Nigeria, the perception is more balanced between genders regarding the recognition and appreciation of unpaid work.

Tanzania shows a similar perception between men and women regarding the recognition and appreciation of unpaid work, with slightly higher percentages among women for most categories.

Overall, there’s a noticeable trend where women often have a slightly stronger belief that unpaid domestic and caring work is recognized and appreciated compared to men, although the differences are not drastic in most cases.

OPEN-ENDED QUESTION

Participants were also asked an open-ended question:

IF YOU COULD TAKE ONE TASK AWAY FROM THE WORK OF WOMEN AT HOME TO MAKE THEIR LIVES EASIER, WHAT WOULD IT BE?

Summary of Responses

There's a prevalent acknowledgment of the immense burden placed on women due to traditional gender roles dictating responsibilities such as cooking, cleaning, fetching water and caring for children. This workload is described as relentless and physically demanding, leaving women with little time for rest or personal pursuits.

"My name is Amani Hango from Usa, Arusha. I strongly believe that household chores should be shared between men and women to expedite tasks. It's not fair to leave all the work to women alone. Thank you."

"In our area mostly unpaid home works are done by women, doing all things at home is their responsibility. In rare cases men do home work but not common."

A man contributing from Fana Sodo Radio, Ethiopia

Furthermore, there's a shared sentiment regarding the need for support and assistance from family members, especially men, in sharing the household workload. The lack of men helping with household chores is identified as a significant challenge, prompting calls for a shift in cultural attitudes towards gender roles within the household. Many respondents emphasized the importance of recognizing and valuing the work that women do, both inside and outside the home.

Despite these challenges, there's also a strong sense of resilience and determination among women to fulfill their roles and responsibilities effectively. There's an aspiration for greater equality in sharing household tasks and a desire for increased support, recognition, and appreciation for women's contributions to the household and family well-being.

"Taking good care of and maintaining the household is a very important aspect that must be done in the family. And men must help their wives with household chores so the stress won't be too concentrated on the women in the house."

A man contributing from BCOS, Nigeria



EPISODE 2: SOCIAL NORMS RELATED TO UNPAID CARE WORK

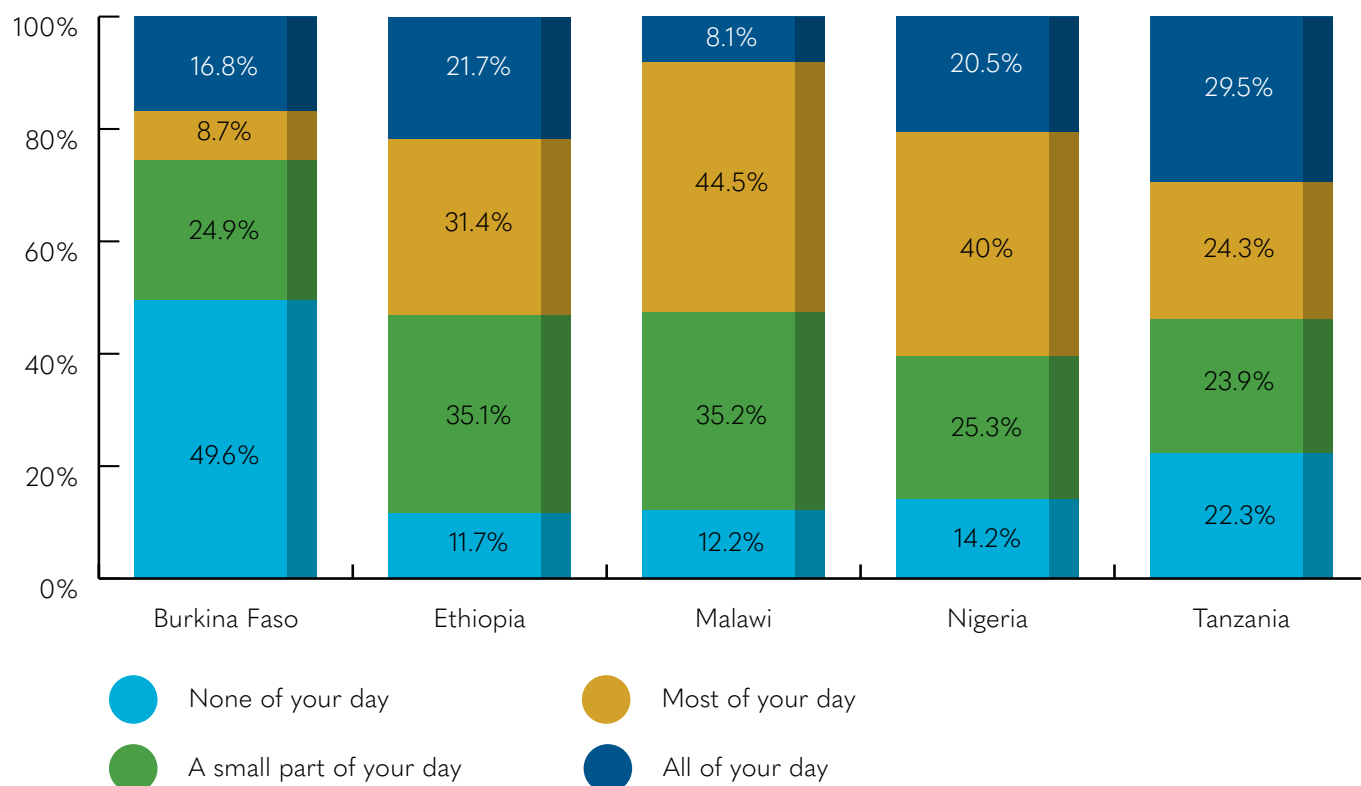
In episode two, we asked respondents four closed-ended questions.

QUESTION 1

HOW MUCH OF YOUR DAY GOES TOWARD DOING UNPAID ACTIVITIES TO ENSURE THE CARE AND SAFETY OF YOUR FAMILY?

1. None of your day
2. A small part of your day
3. Most of your day
4. All of your day

Figure 9: Responses to amount of time spent on unpaid care activities



By the second episode, in Burkina Faso, nearly half of the respondents spend none of their day on unpaid activities for family care, while a substantial portion spends a small part of their day, and a significant but smaller percentage spends most or all of their day on these activities.

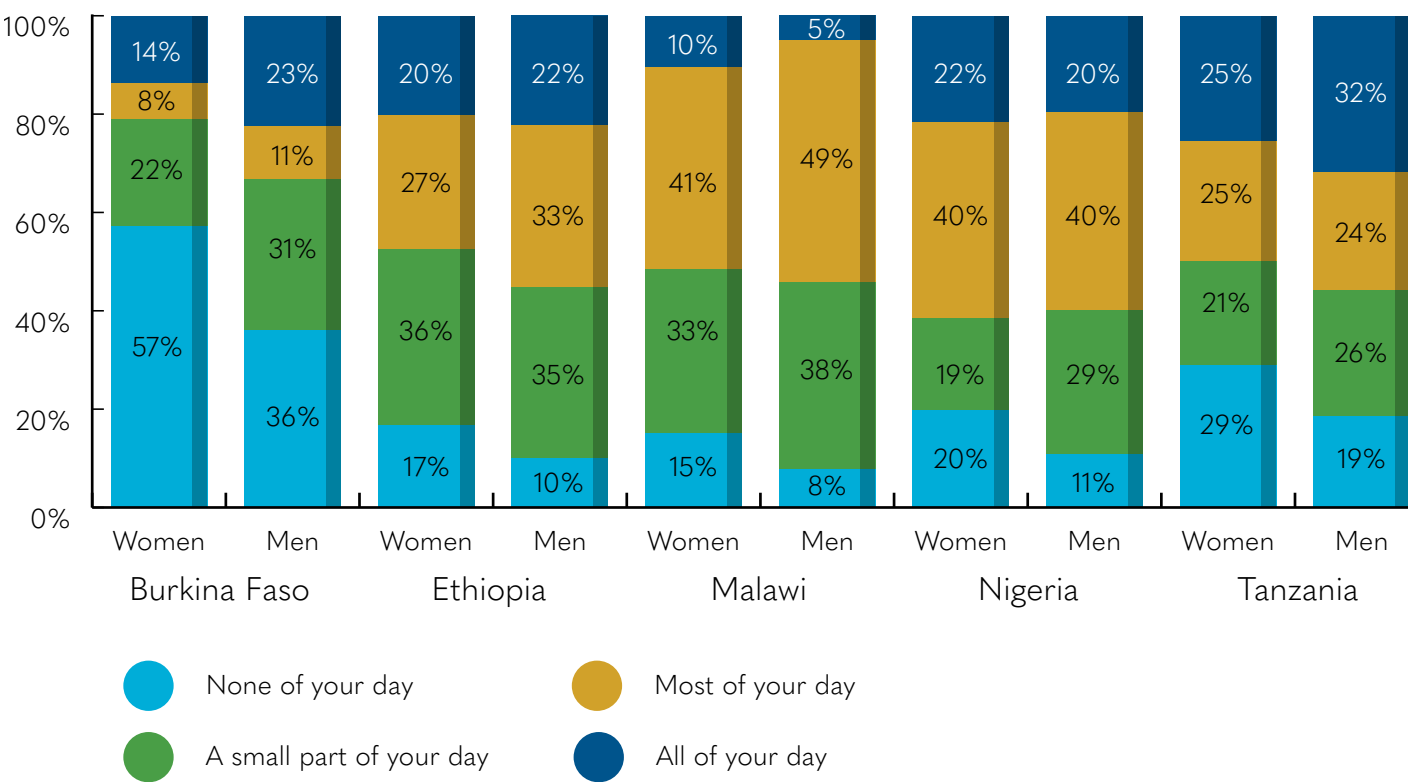
In Ethiopia, a notable percentage spends a small part of their day, and a considerable portion spends most of their day on unpaid activities for family care.

In Malawi, a significant percentage spends most of their day on these activities, while a smaller percentage spends a small part of their day or all of their day on them.

While in Nigeria, a significant percentage spends most of their day on unpaid activities for family care, with a smaller but notable percentage spending a small part of their day or all of their day on these activities.

In Tanzania, a notable percentage spends all of their day on unpaid activities for family care, while a significant but smaller percentage spends most of their day or a small part of their day on these activities.

Figure 10: Responses to the amount of time spent on unpaid care activities by gender



Women in Burkina Faso spend less time overall on unpaid activities for family care compared to men. A higher percentage of women spend none of their day on these activities compared to men, while men spend more time overall across all categories. Men in Burkina Faso dedicate more time to unpaid activities, especially spending a small part of their day and all of their day, compared to women.

In Ethiopia and Malawi, the time spent on these activities seems more balanced between men and women, with variations across the categories.

In Malawi, both men and women spend a significant amount of time, with a notable portion spending most of their day on unpaid activities.

Nigeria shows a similar trend, with women spending more time overall, especially most of their days, but men also dedicate substantial time.

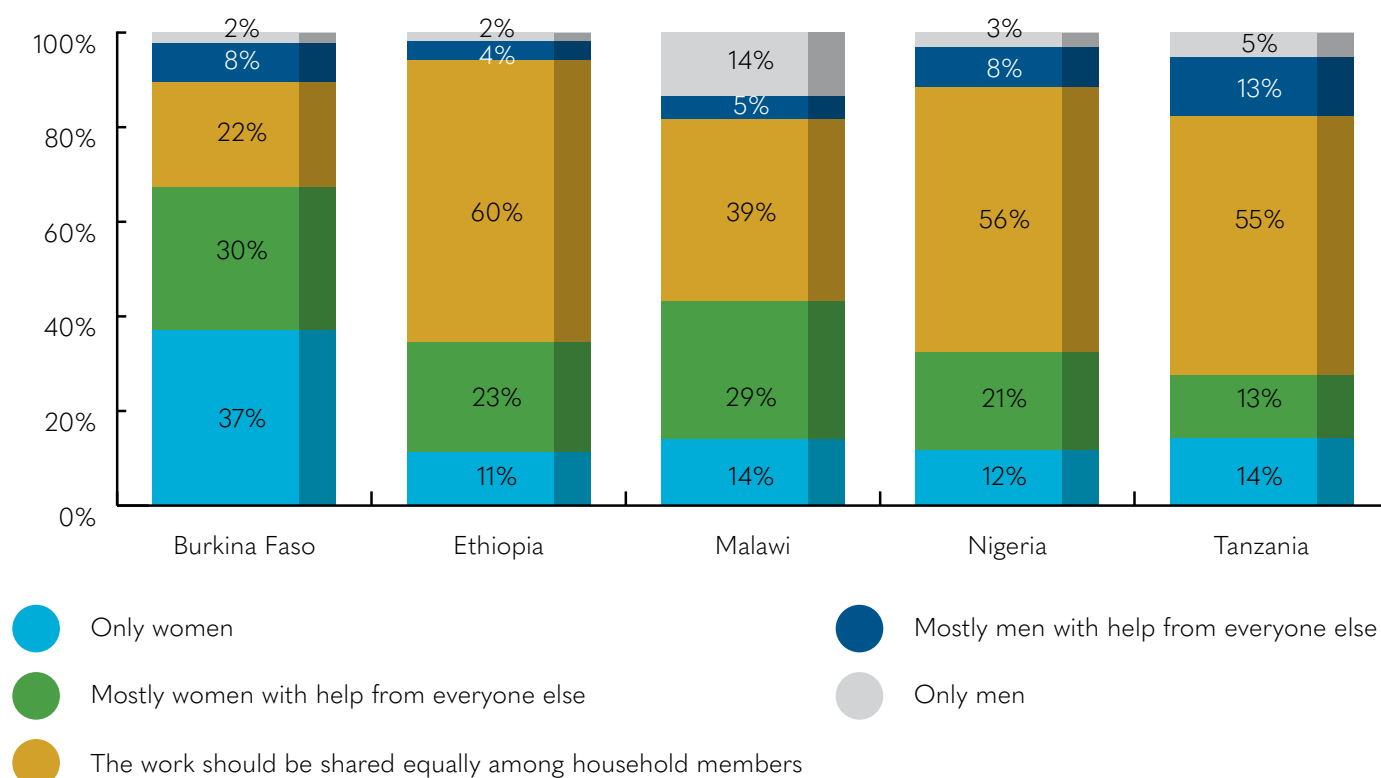
Tanzania exhibits a significant time commitment from both men and women, with men more likely to spend all of their days.

QUESTION 2

WHO, IN YOUR VIEW, SHOULD BE RESPONSIBLE FOR DOING UNPAID CARE TASKS AND DOMESTIC WORK AT HOME?

1. Only women
2. Mostly women with help from everyone else
3. The work should be shared equally among household members
4. Mostly men with help from everyone else
5. Only men

Figure 11: Response to who is responsible for unpaid care tasks



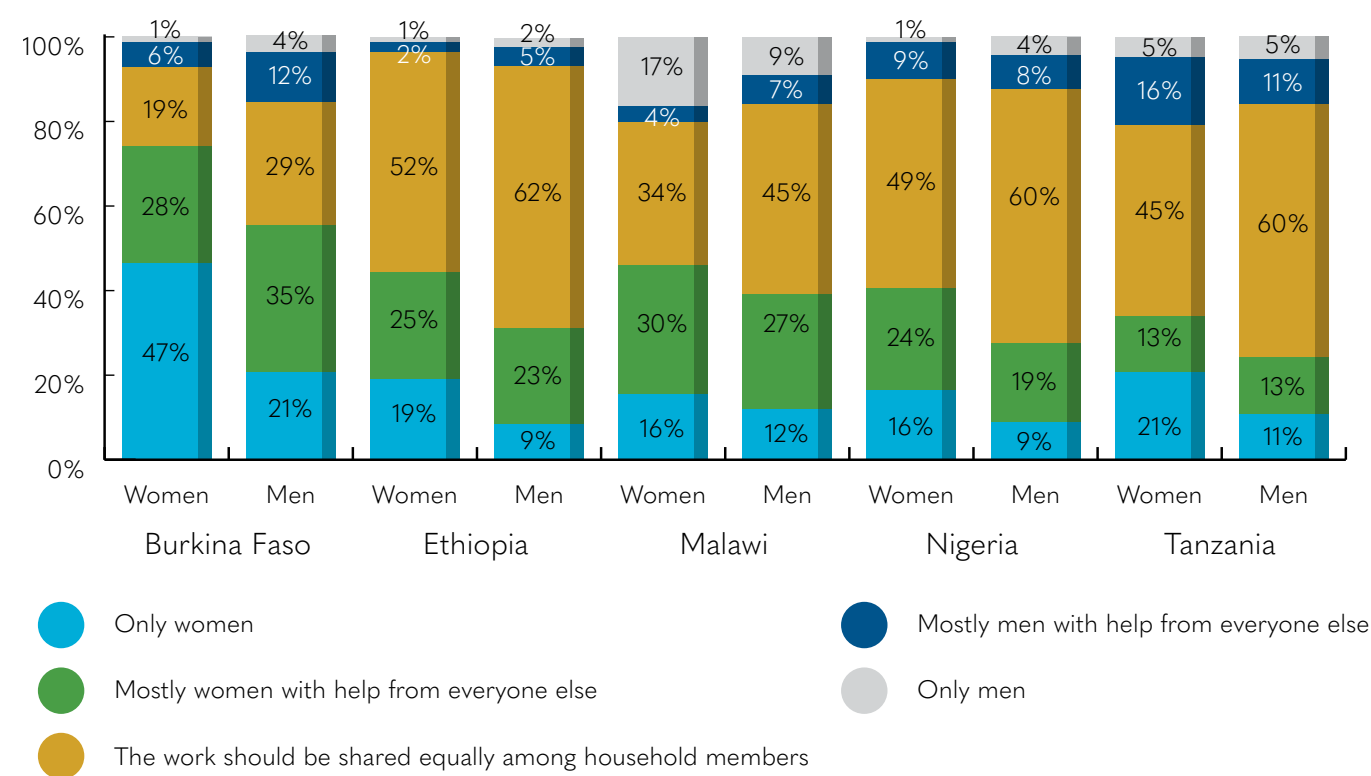
In Burkina Faso, a significant percentage believes that only women should be responsible for unpaid care tasks and domestic work, with a notable portion also suggesting mostly women with help from everyone else.

Ethiopia shows a stark contrast, with a majority advocating for the work to be shared equally among household members.

Malawi and Nigeria also have a substantial percentage advocating for equal sharing of the work among household members, although there are notable percentages favouring mostly women or mostly men with help from others.

Tanzania follows a similar pattern to Malawi and Nigeria, with a significant portion favouring equal sharing among household members but also significant percentages suggesting mostly women or mostly men with help from everyone else.

Figure 12: Response to who is responsible for unpaid care tasks by gender



Only women: Women in Burkina Faso and Tanzania exhibit a higher preference for women being solely responsible for unpaid care tasks, whereas men show less inclination toward this view.

Mostly women with help from everyone else: This view is moderately favoured across genders in most countries, except in Ethiopia where men tend to have a stronger preference for equal sharing.

Equal sharing among household members: This is the preferred option among men in all countries, with Ethiopia and Nigeria showing the highest preference for equal sharing among women as well.

Mostly men with help from everyone else: This view is less favoured overall but has slightly higher acceptance among men in Malawi and Tanzania.

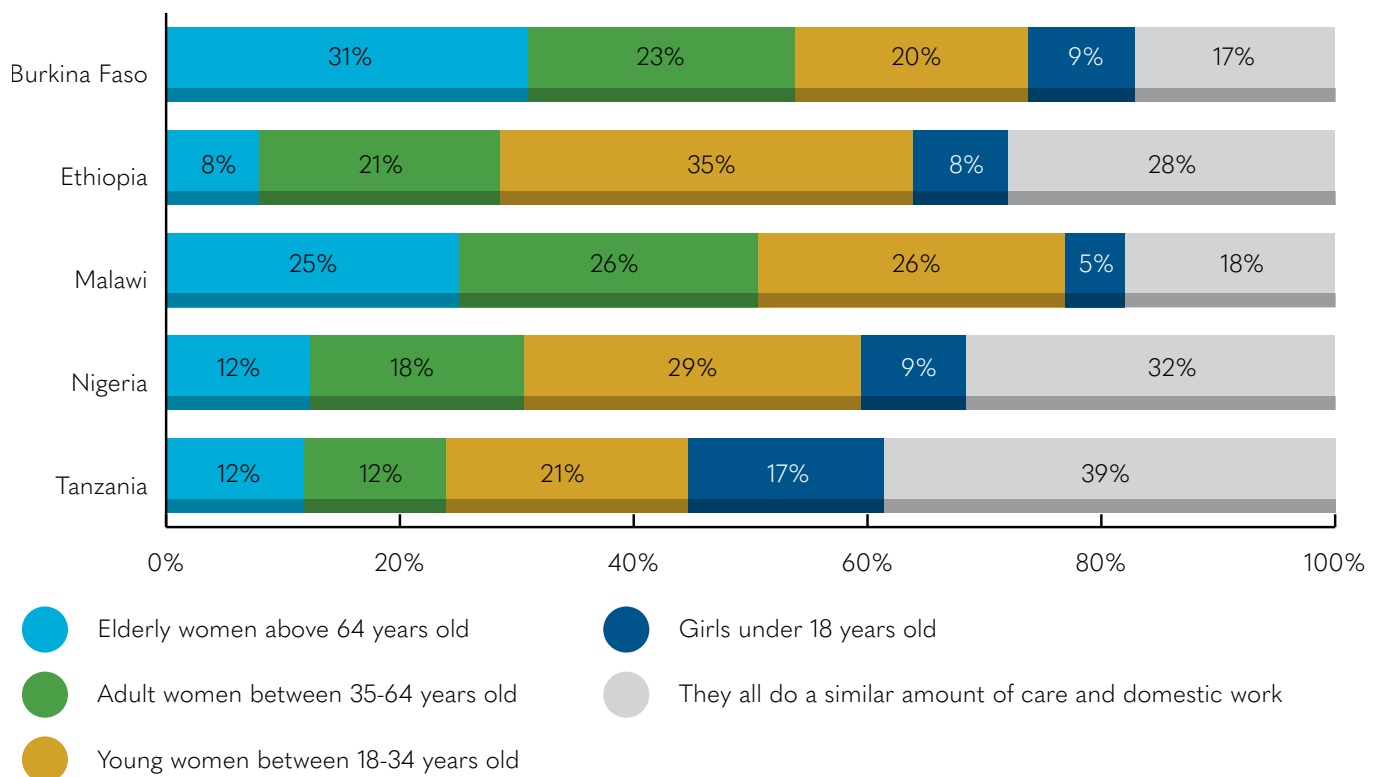
Only men: This view is the least favoured overall across genders and countries.

QUESTION 3

IN YOUR COMMUNITY, WHO AMONG THE FOLLOWING IS DOING MOST OF THE UNPAID CARE TASKS AND DOMESTIC WORK AT HOME?

1. Elderly women above 64 years old
2. Adult women between 35-64 years old
3. Young women between 18-34 years old
4. Girls under 18 years old
5. They all do a similar amount of care and domestic work

Figure 13: Response to who does most unpaid care tasks at home



Elderly women above 64 years old: Burkina Faso and Malawi perceive this group as doing the most unpaid care tasks and domestic work at home.

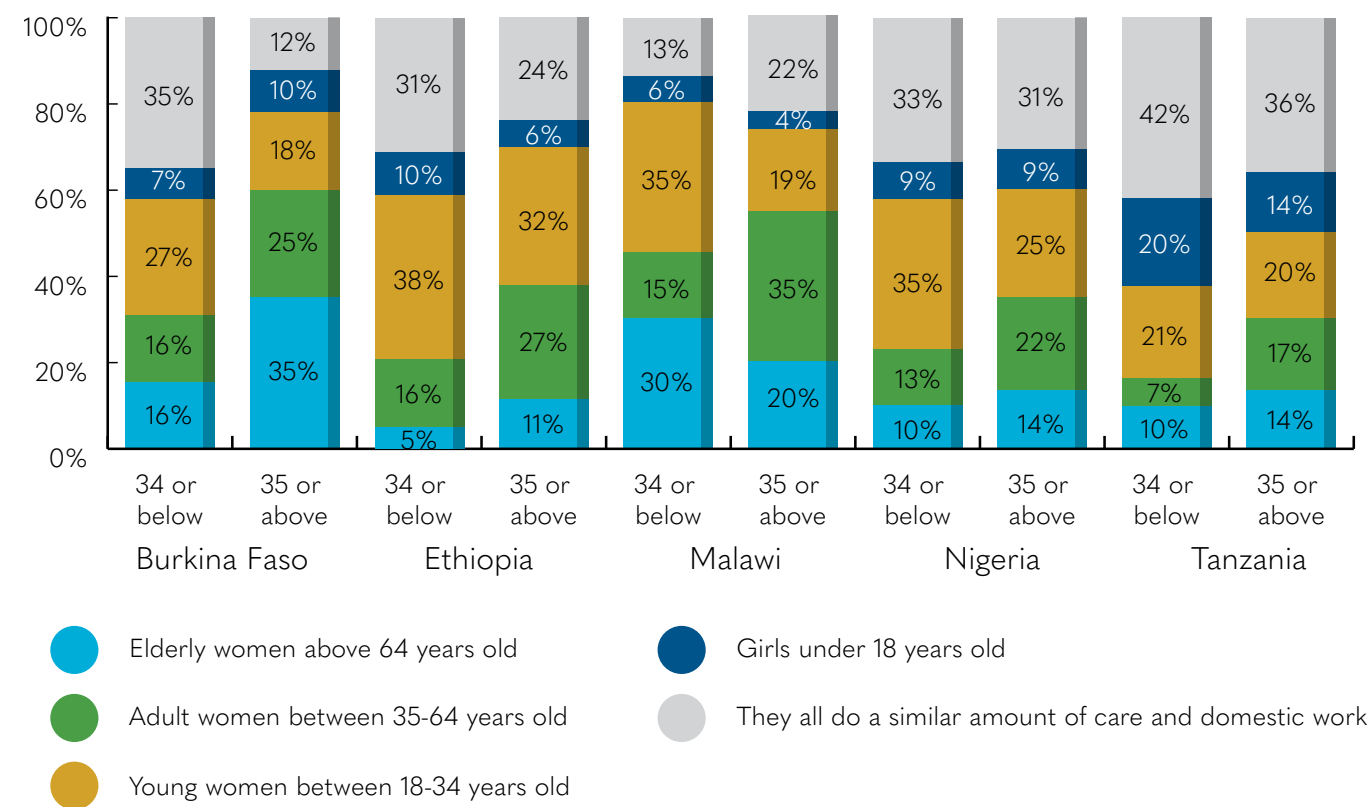
Adult women between 35-64 years old: This group is perceived to do a significant portion of the work across all countries, especially in Ethiopia.

Young women between 18-34 years old: Ethiopia and Nigeria view this group as shouldering a considerable amount of the care and domestic work.

Girls under 18 years old: Tanzania sees girls under 18 as contributing significantly to unpaid care tasks and domestic work.

They all do a similar amount of care and domestic work: Tanzania stands out with a significant proportion of people believing that all groups contribute equally, followed by Nigeria.

Figure 14: Response to who does most unpaid care tasks at home by age



Across all communities, there’s a notable perception that young women between 18-34 years old contribute significantly to unpaid care tasks and domestic work.

In Burkina Faso, elderly women above 64 years old are seen as contributing the most, especially among those aged 35 or above.

Ethiopia also acknowledges the significant contribution of young women, particularly those below 35 years old.

Malawi and Nigeria highlight the role of adult women between 35-64 years old in contributing to unpaid care tasks and domestic work, although the younger age group is also seen as contributing significantly.

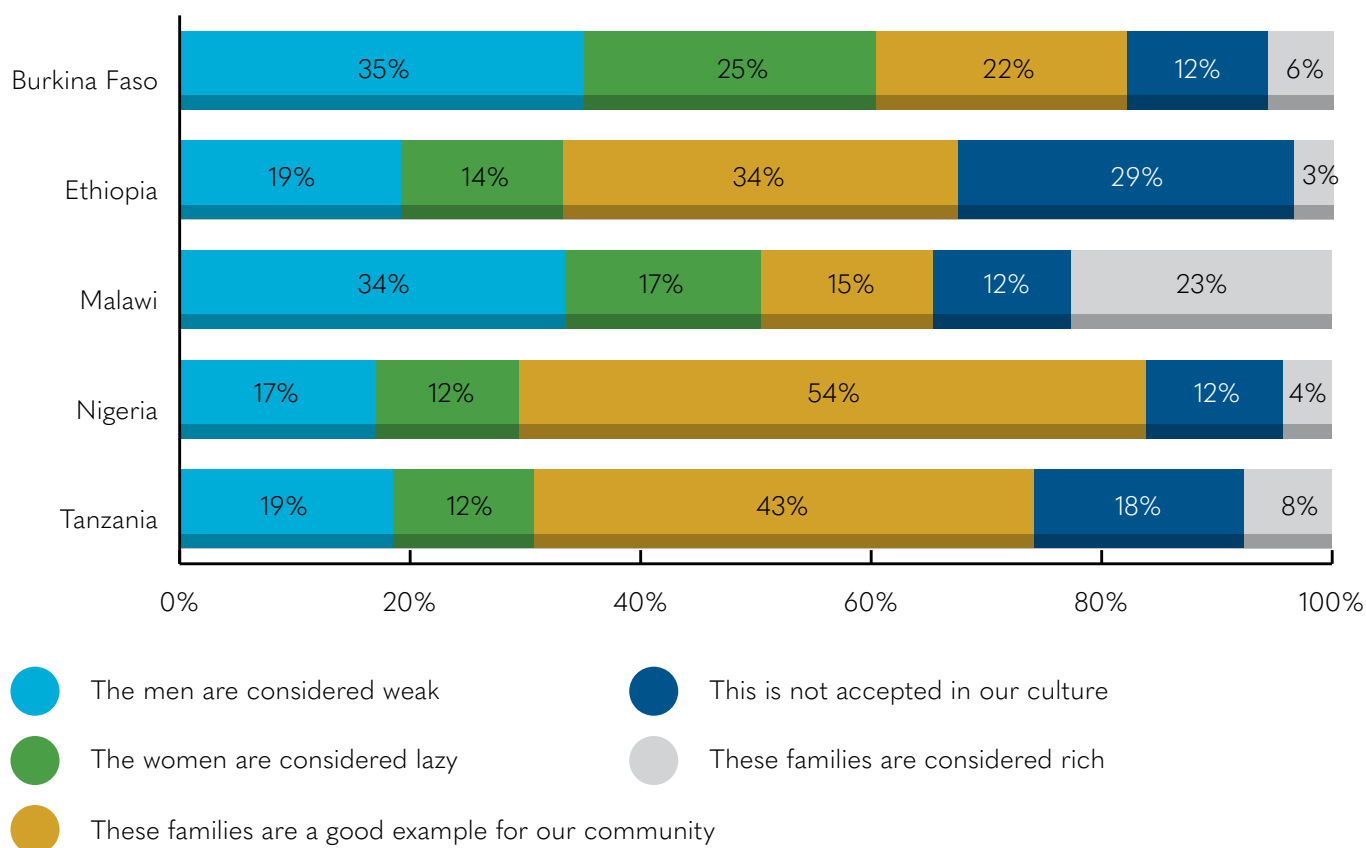
Tanzania stands out with a higher perception of girls under 18 years old contributing substantially, especially among those aged 34 or below.

QUESTION 4

IN YOUR COMMUNITY, HOW ARE FAMILIES PERCEIVED WHEN MEN AND WOMEN SHARE THE UNPAID CARE TASKS AND DOMESTIC WORK AT HOME?

1. The men are considered weak
2. The women are considered lazy
3. These families are a good example for our community
4. This is not accepted in our culture
5. These families are considered rich

Figure 15: Response to perception of families when unpaid care work is shared



Men considered weak: Burkina Faso, Malawi and Tanzania have higher percentages of respondents believing that when men share unpaid care tasks, they are seen as weak.

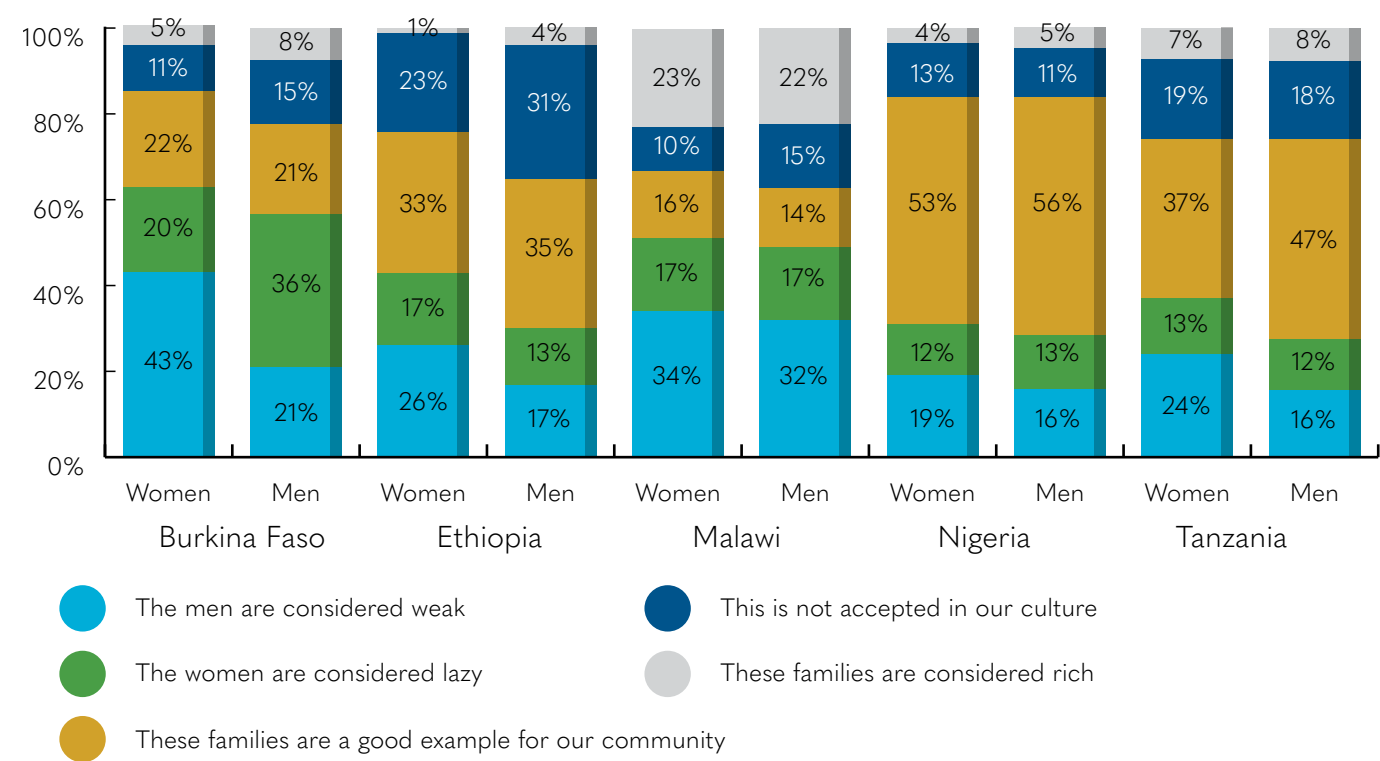
Women considered lazy: This perception is present in all countries, with the highest in Burkina Faso and Ethiopia.

Good example for the community: Nigeria stands out significantly, with a majority seeing such families as a good example.

Not accepted in culture: Ethiopia and Tanzania have higher percentages of people believing that this sharing is not accepted in their culture.

Considered rich: Malawi stands out with a considerable percentage perceiving such families as wealthy.

Figure 16: Response to perception of families when unpaid care work is shared by gender



The perception of men being considered weak is higher among women in all communities, except in Nigeria. In Malawi, a considerable percentage of men also hold this view of themselves.

The perception of women being considered lazy is more prevalent among men in all communities, except in Burkina Faso and Tanzania where women themselves have a higher perception of being considered lazy.

Across all communities, there’s a notable proportion of people who believe that families where men and women share unpaid care tasks are a good example for the community, especially among men in Nigeria and Tanzania.

The perception that such sharing is not accepted in their culture is present across all communities but varies in intensity.

The belief that these families are considered rich is more prevalent among women in Malawi and Nigeria, while in other communities, both genders share this perception fairly equally.

OPEN-ENDED QUESTION

The open-ended question for episode two was:

WHAT CHANGES WOULD YOU LIKE TO MAKE TO HOW UNPAID CARE TASKS AND DOMESTIC WORK IS SHARED IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD?

Summary of Responses

There's a strong emphasis on the need for awareness and education about unpaid domestic work, with suggestions for religious and government leaders to take responsibility in creating this awareness. The importance of sharing all household tasks equally among family members, regardless of gender, is highlighted repeatedly. There's a recognition that unpaid domestic work is not solely women's work but should be shared by all household members.

"My contribution is everyone, irrespective of gender, should be involved in unpaid care job. There should be accurate division of labour among men and women..."

A woman contributing from Arewa FM, Nigeria

Several voices call for a shift in cultural attitudes that assign specific tasks based on gender. Participants express their experiences of sharing household chores with their spouses and families, highlighting the positive impact of equal participation in unpaid work on family dynamics and relationships. There's also a call for youth and children to be involved in household tasks to foster a sense of responsibility and equality from a young age.

"The state needs to find a way of raising awareness so that men know that there is no work dedicated only to women. This will enable families to better organize themselves to make changes in unpaid care activities."

A woman contributing from Radio Loudon, Burkina Faso

Additionally, concerns are raised about the impact of solely assigning unpaid work to women, including health risks and societal pressures. Participants stress the importance of valuing and appreciating the work done within the household, advocating for mutual support and cooperation among family members.



EPISODE 3: MAKING CHANGE

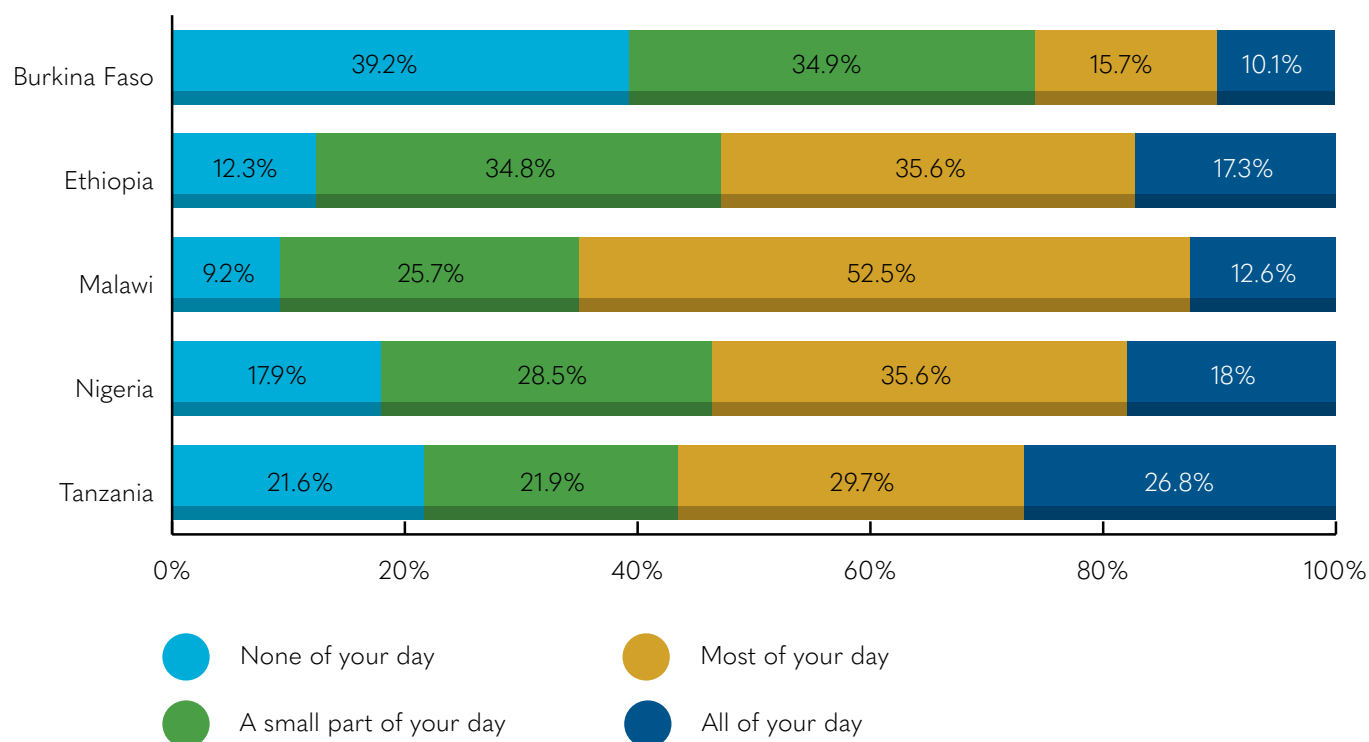
In episode three, we asked respondents three closed-ended questions.

QUESTION 1

HOW MUCH OF YOUR DAY GOES TOWARD DOING UNPAID ACTIVITIES TO ENSURE THE CARE AND SAFETY OF YOUR FAMILY?

1. None of your day
2. A small part of your day
3. Most of your day
4. All of your day

Figure 17: Responses to amount of time spent on unpaid care activities



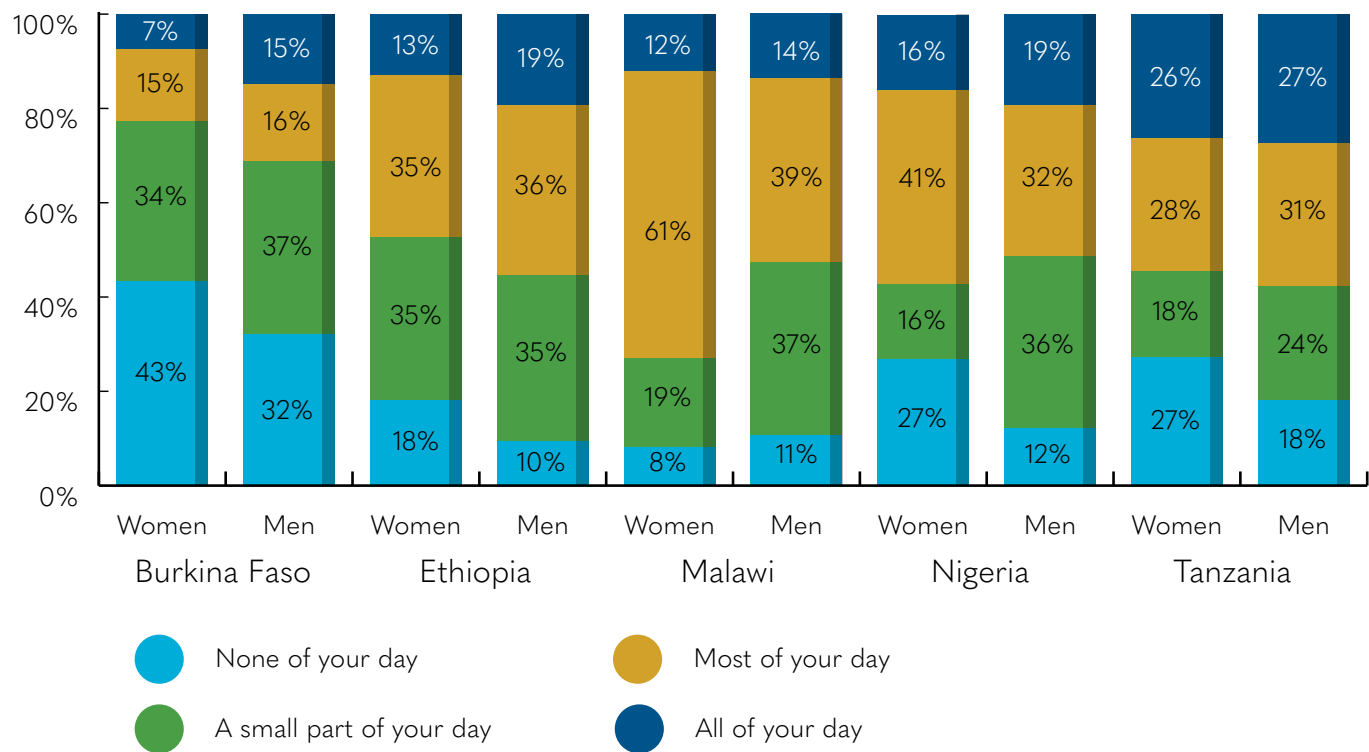
None of your day: This category is highest in Burkina Faso, followed by Tanzania and Nigeria.

A small part of your day: Ethiopia has the lowest percentage in this category, while Malawi and Nigeria have higher percentages.

Most of your day: Malawi stands out, with over half of respondents spending most of their day on unpaid activities for family care. Ethiopia also has a significant percentage in this category.

All of your day: Tanzania has the highest percentage of people spending all of their day, followed by Ethiopia.

Figure 18: Responses to amount of time spent on unpaid care activities by gender



None of your day: Women in Burkina Faso and Tanzania have higher percentages in this category compared to men, indicating a greater number of women not engaging in unpaid activities for family care during the day.

A small part of your day: Men in Ethiopia and Nigeria have higher percentages compared to women, indicating more men spending a small part of their day on unpaid activities.

Most of your day: Women in Malawi spend significantly more time in this category compared to men, indicating a higher burden of unpaid care tasks among women in Malawi. In Ethiopia, men spend more time compared to women in this category.

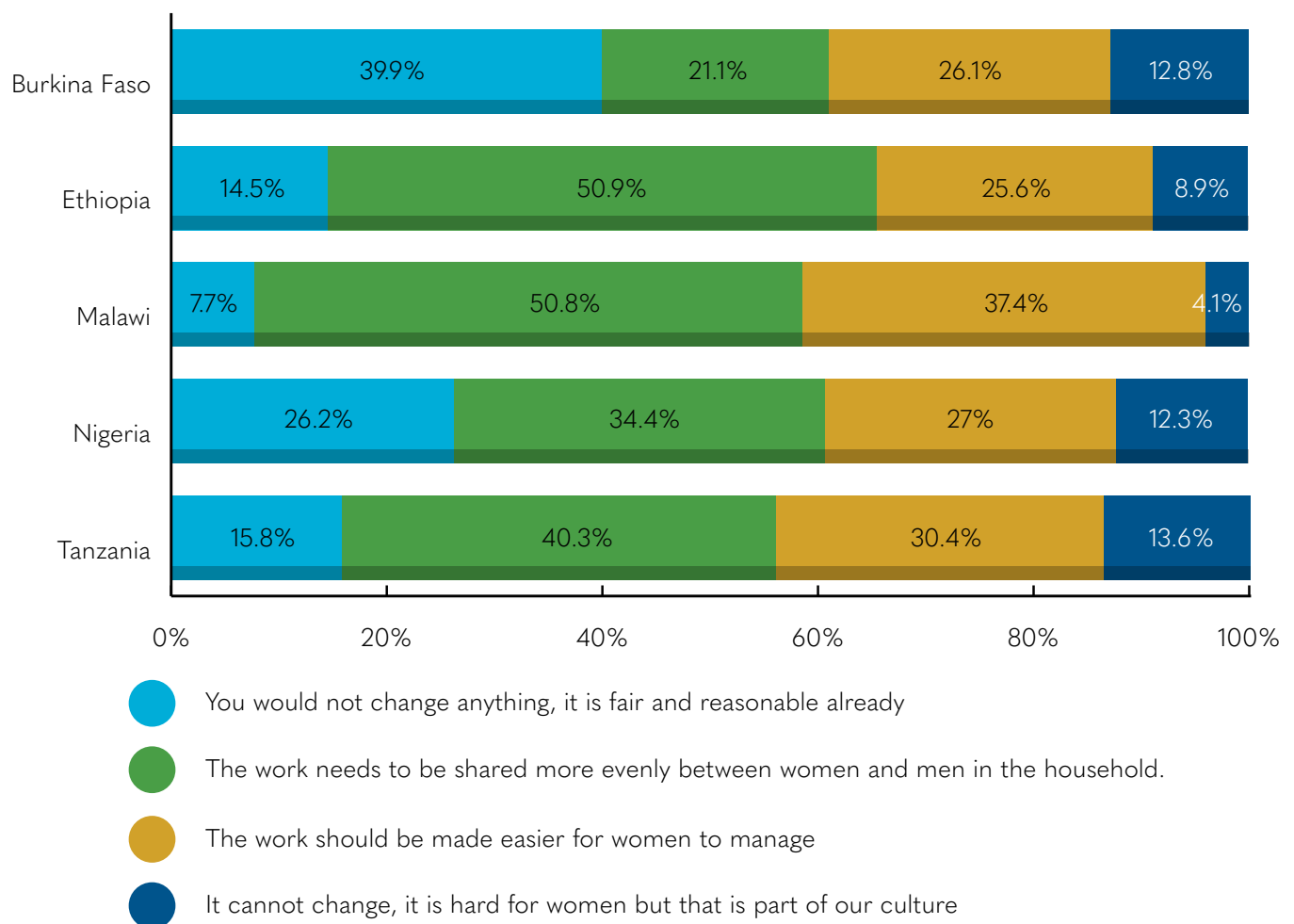
All of your day: Women in Burkina Faso, Nigeria and Tanzania have lower percentages in this category compared to men, suggesting that fewer women spend their entire day on unpaid care tasks. However, in Ethiopia and Malawi, the percentages are relatively similar between men and women spending all of their day on unpaid activities.

QUESTION 2

WHAT WOULD YOU CHANGE IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD, IF ANYTHING, TO MAKE THE WORK OF CARING FOR YOUR FAMILY EASIER AND MORE MANAGEABLE FOR WOMEN?

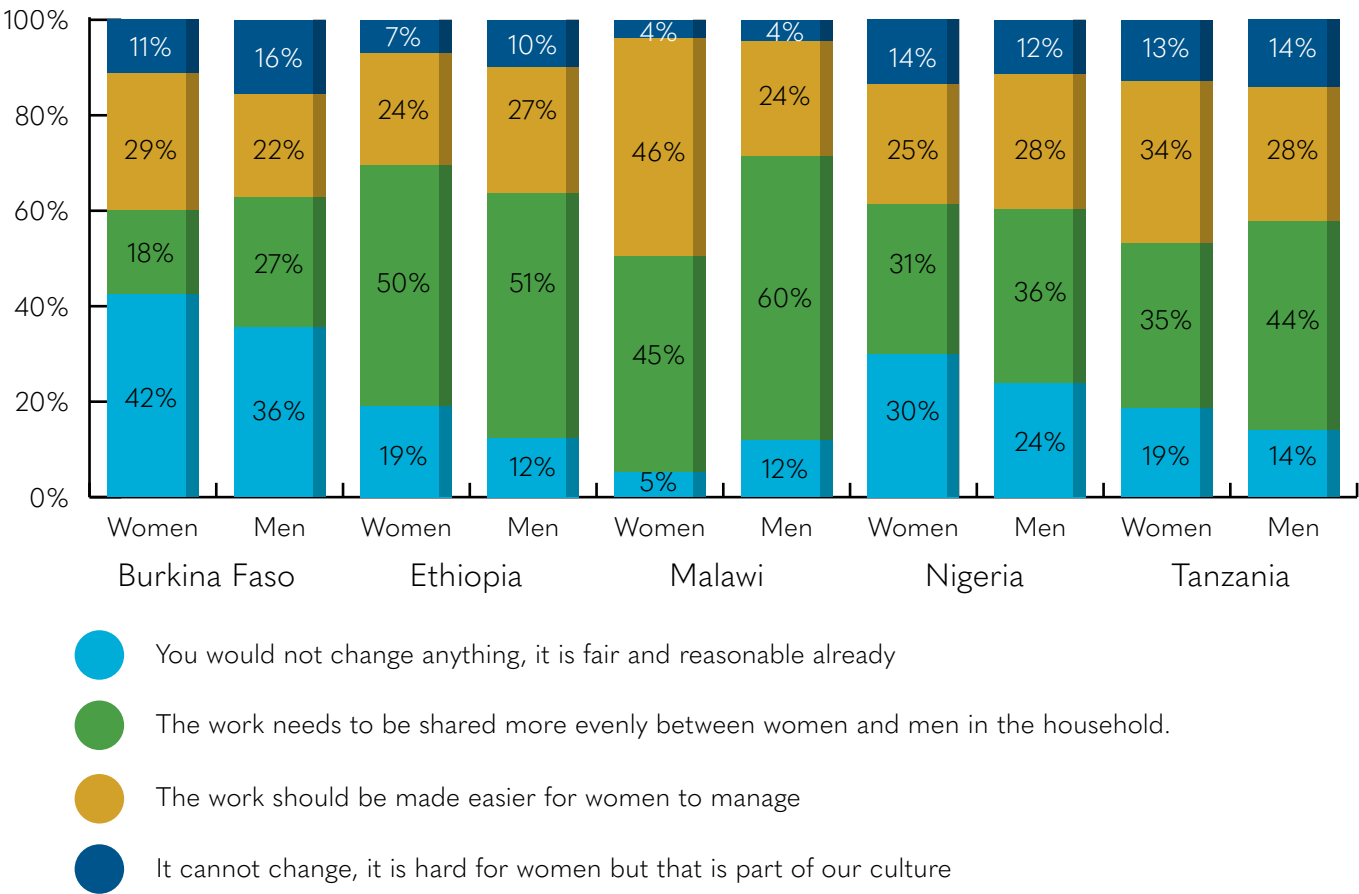
1. You would not change anything, it is fair and reasonable already
2. The work needs to be shared more evenly between women and men in the household.
3. The work should be made easier for women to manage
4. It cannot change, it is hard for women but that is part of our culture

Figure 19: Responses to what changes in the household would make unpaid care easier



The majority of respondents in all countries believe that the work needs to be shared more evenly between women and men in the household to make caring for the family easier and more manageable for women. There is a significant percentage in each country who believe that the work should be made easier for women to manage, suggesting a recognition of the challenges women face in unpaid care work. A smaller percentage of respondents believe that the current situation is fair and reasonable or that the difficulties faced by women are part of their culture and cannot be changed.

Figure 20: Responses to what changes in the household would make unpaid care easier by gender



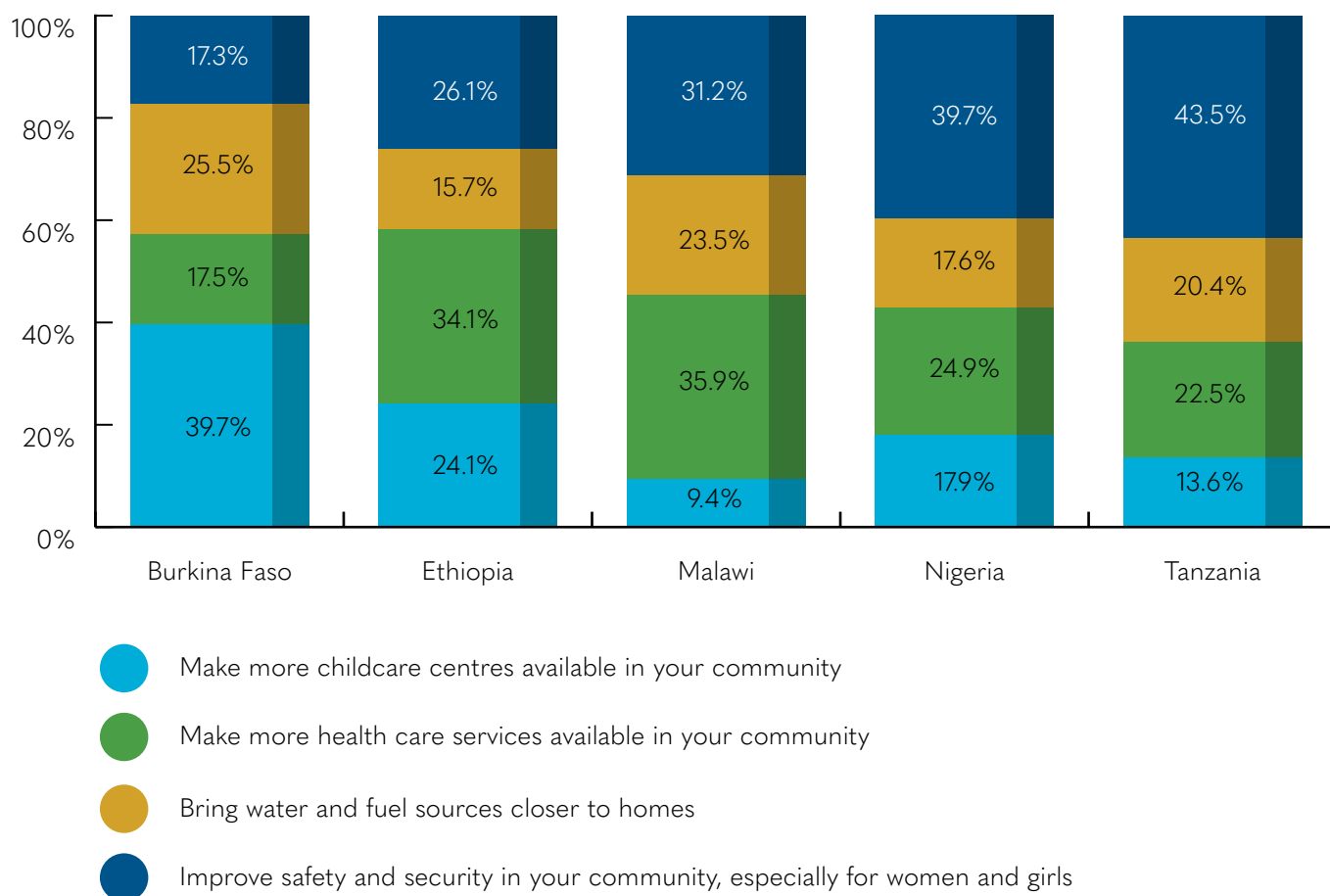
Across most countries, both men and women acknowledge the need for a more equal sharing of household work between genders. This sentiment is particularly strong in Ethiopia, Malawi and Tanzania. A significant percentage in each country believes that the work should be made easier for women to manage, suggesting an awareness of the challenges women face in household responsibilities. A minority in each country feels that the current situation is fair and reasonable or that the challenges faced by women are cultural and cannot be changed, with this sentiment being more pronounced among men in some countries like Burkina Faso and Ethiopia.

QUESTION 3

WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING ACTIONS SHOULD BE A TOP PRIORITY FOR GOVERNMENTS TO MAKE CARE WORK EASIER, ESPECIALLY FOR WOMEN?

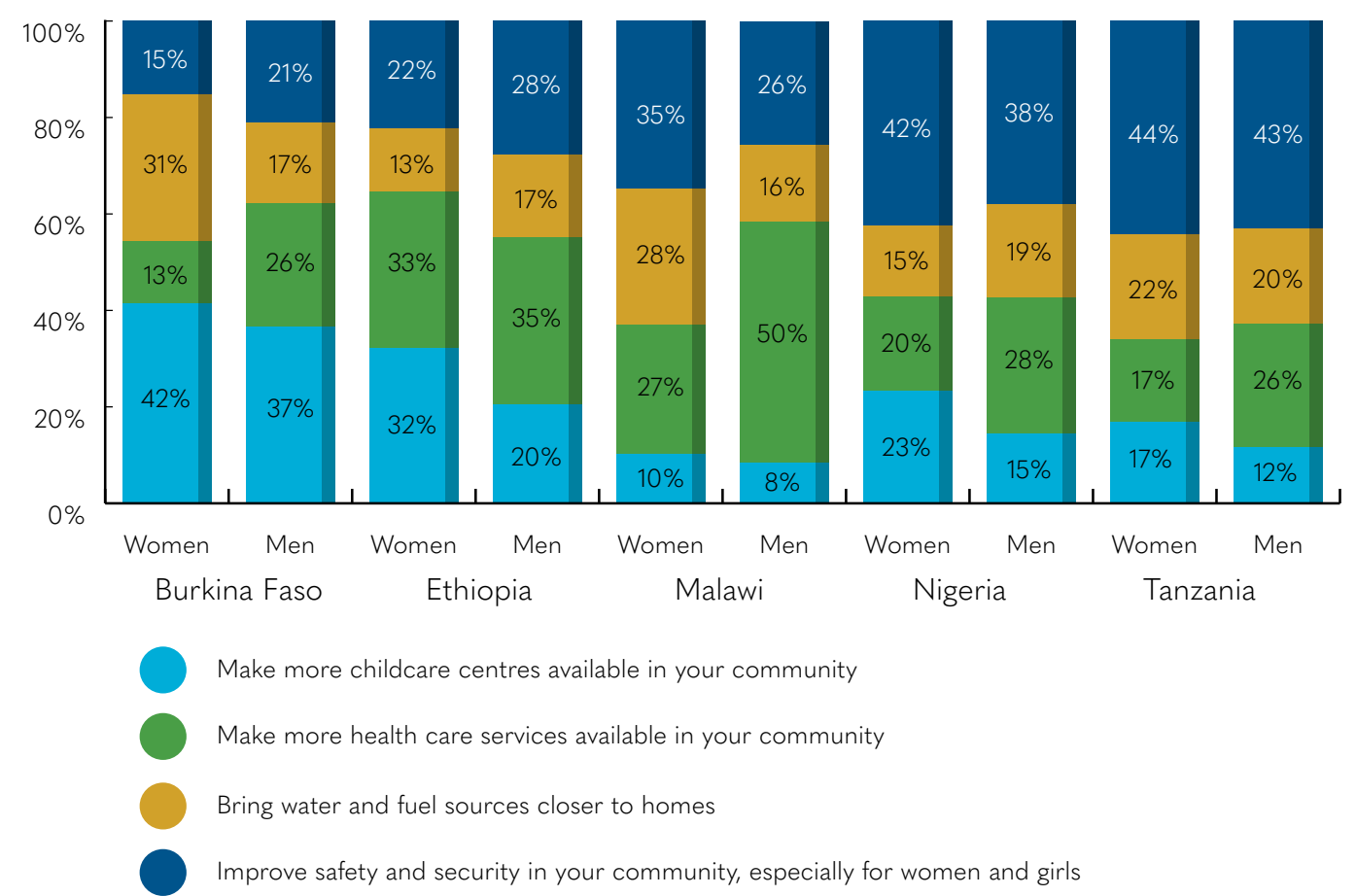
1. Make more childcare centres available in your community
2. Make more health care services available in your community
3. Bring water and fuel sources closer to homes
4. Improve safety and security in your community, especially for women and girls

Figure 21: Response to top priority for governments to make unpaid care easier for women



Across the board, the top priority for governments to make care work easier for women varies. In Burkina Faso, the establishment of childcare centers is the top need. In Tanzania, improving safety and security, especially for women and girls, is seen as a significant priority. Malawi prioritizes making more health care services available. Ethiopia emphasizes both childcare centres and health care services. Nigeria focuses heavily on improving safety and security for women and girls.

Figure 22: Response to top priority for governments to make unpaid care easier for women by gender



Women across most countries prioritize making more childcare centres available, with the highest emphasis in Burkina Faso. Men in Malawi also prioritize this, while men in other countries show less emphasis. Men in Ethiopia and women in Malawi prioritize making more health care services available. Men in Nigeria show some priority for this as well. Women in Tanzania prioritize bringing water and fuel sources closer to their homes. Men generally show less emphasis on this across all countries. Women in Nigeria and Tanzania prioritize improving safety and security, especially for women and girls. Men across most countries also prioritize this, with significant emphasis in Nigeria and Tanzania.

OPEN-ENDED QUESTION

The open-ended question for episode three was:

IF YOU COULD TALK TO SOMEBODY IN A POSITION OF AUTHORITY WHAT ADVICE WOULD YOU GIVE ABOUT HOW TO MAKE THE WORK OF CARING FOR YOUR FAMILY AND LOOKING AFTER THE HOUSEHOLD EASIER?

Summary of Responses

There's a consensus that all family members should participate equally in domestic work, regardless of gender, to alleviate the pressure on women and promote equality within households.

"Women and men should always do equal work and be treated equally. They should share power equally and participate equally in any work."

A woman contributing from Shashemene FM, Ethiopia

Participants suggest that government officials and leaders should prioritize creating awareness and implementing policies that encourage shared responsibilities at home. They emphasize the importance of educational programs and public awareness campaigns to change societal attitudes towards unpaid work and gender roles.

"I also urge the government to pay greater attention to women's issues, as currently, about 90% of women work as much as men. However, women still face more financial discrimination, so the government should consider us from a different perspective, a more holistic one."

A woman contributing from Sauti Ya Injili FM, Tanzania

Many voices stress the need for practical support, such as improving infrastructure like water access, health care services, and energy sources, especially in rural areas. This support is seen as essential in reducing the physical strain on women and making household tasks more manageable.

"If we have water at hand, our worries are over. If we have water, everything else becomes easy, laundry, children's hygiene, washing up and everything else becomes really easy for us. That's what I was going to ask the authorities."

A woman contributing from Radio Zam FM, Burkina Faso

There's also a call for closer interaction between government officials and the community to address specific challenges related to unpaid care work and household management. Participants highlight the importance of understanding and responding to the needs of individuals and families to promote overall well-being and gender equality.



CONCLUSION

The analysis highlights the multifaceted nature of unpaid care work and domestic responsibilities within households across Burkina Faso, Ethiopia, Malawi, Nigeria, and Tanzania. Women generally shoulder a significant burden of these tasks, although there are evolving trends towards more equitable sharing of responsibilities. Key challenges identified include the need for improved access to childcare facilities, health care services, and basic infrastructure like water and fuel sources. Moreover, enhancing safety and security, particularly for women and girls, emerged as a critical priority in several countries. Cultural norms and perceptions play a crucial role in shaping attitudes towards unpaid care work, with varying degrees of acceptance and calls for change within communities. Ultimately, addressing these challenges requires comprehensive policies and societal shifts that promote gender equality, shared responsibilities, and support systems to make care work easier and more manageable, especially for women.

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Farm Radio International is a Canadian international non-governmental organization uniquely focused on improving the lives of rural Africans through the world's most accessible communications tool, radio, in combination with Information and Communications Technologies (ICTs).



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